

DEGREES OF COMPARISON

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Degrees of Comparison

- Adjectives are used to describe, quantify, modify or identify nouns/pronouns.
- Adjectives have their own degrees called degrees of adjectives or degrees of comparison that compare one thing/person to another.

Degrees of Comparison

Comparatives & Superlatives



Degrees of Comparison

Comparatives &
Superlatives



Degrees of Comparison

Comparatives & Superlatives



sad



sadder



saddest

Degrees of Comparison

Comparatives &
Superlatives



Degrees of Comparison

Comparatives &
Superlatives



Degrees of Comparison

Comparatives &
Superlatives



Degrees of Comparison



HAPPY



HAPPIER



THE HAPPIEST



GOOD



BETTER



THE BEST



USEFUL



MORE USEFUL



THE MOST USEFUL



YOUNG



YOUNGER



THE YOUNGEST



SWEET



SWEETER



THE SWEETEST



HOT



HOTTER



THE HOTTEST

Degrees of Comparison

1. Comparison with *-er/-est*

clean → clean**er** → (the) clean**est**

We use *-er/-est* with the following adjectives:

1.1. Adjectives with one syllable

positive	comparative	superlative
clean	clean er	clean est
new	new er	new est
cheap	cheap er	cheap est

Degrees of Comparison

1. Comparison with *-er/-est*

clean → clean**er** → (the) clean**est**

We use *-er/-est* with the following adjectives:

1.2. Adjectives with two syllables and the following endings:

1.2.1. Adjectives with two syllables, ending in *-y*

positive	comparative	superlative
dirty	dirty er	dirty est
easy	eas ier	eas iest
happy	happ ier	happ iest
pretty	prett ier	prett iest

Degrees of Comparison

1. Comparison with *-er/-est*

clean → clean**er** → (the) clean**est**

We use *-er/-est* with the following adjectives:

1.2. Adjectives with two syllables and the following endings:

1.2.2. Adjectives with two syllables, ending in *-er*

positive	comparative	superlative
clever	clever er	clever est

Degrees of Comparison

1. Comparison with *-er/-est*

clean → clean**er** → (the) clean**est**

We use *-er/-est* with the following adjectives:

1.2. Adjectives with two syllables and the following endings:

1.2.3. Adjectives with two syllables, ending in *-le*

positive	comparative	superlative
simple	simpl er	simpl est

Degrees of Comparison

1. Comparison with *-er/-est*

clean → clean**er** → (the) clean**est**

We use *-er/-est* with the following adjectives:

1.2. Adjectives with two syllables and the following endings:

1.2.4. Adjectives with two syllables, ending in *-ow*

positive	comparative	superlative
narrow	narrow er	narrow est

Degrees of Comparison

1. Comparison with *-er/-est*

clean → clean**er** → (the) clean**est**

We use *-er/-est* with the following adjectives:

1.3. Spelling of the adjectives using the endings *-er/-est*

positive	comparative	superlative	comment
large	larg er	larg est	leave out the silent -e
big	bigg er	bigg est	Double the consonant after short vowel
sad	sadd er	sadd est	
dirty	dirt ier	dirt i est	Change -y to -i (consonant before -y)
shy	shy er	shy est	Here -y is not changed to -i. (although consonant before -y)

Degrees of Comparison

2. Comparison with *more* – *most*

all adjectives with **more than one syllable** except some adjectives with two syllables

positive	comparative	superlative
difficult	more difficult	(the) most difficult

Degrees of Comparison

3. Irregular adjectives

positive	comparative	superlative	comment
good	better	best	
bad	worse	worst	
much	more	most	uncountable nouns
many	more	most	countable nouns
little	less	least	
small	smaller	smallest	

Lesser: It is a comparative form of *little*, but it is used specifically to mean "of lower importance, value, or quality" rather than a smaller quantity.

Example: "Of two evils, choose the **lesser**."

Degrees of Comparison

4. Special adjectives

Some adjectives have **two** possible **forms** of comparison (-er/est and *more/most*).

positive	comparative	superlative
clever	cleverer / more clever	cleverest / most clever
common	commoner / more common	commonest / most common
likely	likelier / more likely	likeliest / most likely
pleasant	pleasanter / more pleasant	pleasantest / most pleasant
polite	politer / more polite	politest / most polite
quiet	quieter / more quiet	quietest / most quiet
simple	simpler / more simple	simplest / most simple
stupid	stupider / more stupid	stupidest / most stupid
subtle	subtler / more subtle	subtlest / most subtle
sure	surer / more sure	surest / most sure

Degrees of Comparison

5. Difference in meaning with adjectives

positive	comparative	superlative	comment
far	farther	farthest	distance
	further	furthest	distance <i>or</i> time
late	later	latest	
	latter	x	
	x	last	
old	older	oldest	people and things
	elder	eldest	people (family)
near	nearer	nearest	distance
	x	next	order

Degrees of Comparison

Sentences with comparisons in English

1. something is similar A=B

Our car is **as fast as** Peter's car.

Degrees of Comparison

Sentences with comparisons in English

2. something is not similar $A \neq B$

2.1. Use *not as ... as* (to say that something is not similar)

John's car **is not as fast as** our car. ($A \neq B$)

2.2. Use *than* (to say that something is bigger or smaller)

Our car is **faster than** John's car. ($A > B$)

John's car **is slower than** our car. ($A < B$)

NOTE!

- Peter is **taller than** me. (*informal*)
- Peter is **taller than** I am. (*formal*)

- Max is **as tall as** me. (*informal*)
- Max is **as tall as** I am. (*formal*)

Degrees of Comparison

Sentences with comparisons in English

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NOTE!

- Peter is **taller than** me. (*informal*)
- Peter is **taller than** I am. (*formal*)
- Max is **as tall as** me. (*informal*)
- Max is **as tall as** I am. (*formal*)

He is taller than I. ✓

He is taller than I am. ✓ ✓

Adjectives have three degrees of comparison

- POSITIVE DEGREE
- John is **tall**.
- COMPARATIVE DEGREE
- Peter is **taller** than John.
- SUPERLATIVE DEGREE
- Rajesh is the **tallest** boy in the class.

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 1 (a)

When two things/persons are compared, a comparative degree is used with the word 'than'.

- She is **smarter than** her sister.
- She is **more cheerful than** her sister.

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 1 (b)

When more than two things/people are compared, the superlative degree is used with 'the' before the adjective.

- He is the **strongest** wrestler.
- He is the **most handsome** actor in the industry.????

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 2

- Jim is **smarter** than clever.

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 2

‘More’ is used when you compare qualities of a single thing/person. Even if the first adjective is a single syllable word.

- Jim is **smarter** than clever.

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 2

‘More’ is used when you compare qualities of a single thing/person. Even if the first adjective is a single-syllable word.

- Jim is **smarter** than clever. **X**

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 2

‘More’ is used when you compare qualities of a **single** thing/person. Even if the first adjective is a single syllable word.

- Jim is **smarter** than clever. **X**
- Jim is **more smart** than clever. 

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 2

‘More’ is used when you compare qualities of a **single** thing/person. Even if the first adjective is a single syllable word.

- Jim is **smarter** than clever. **X**

- Jim is **more smart** than clever.



BUT

- Jim is **smarter** than John



Degrees of Comparison: Rule 3

Do not use double **comparative** adjectives or **superlative** adjectives.

- These mangoes are more tastier than those. **X**
- These mangoes are **tastier** than those. 
- These mangoes are the **most tastiest**. **X**

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 4

Never use 'more or most' with adjectives that give absolute sense.

- This track is more parallel than that one. 
- This track is parallel and the other is not. 

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 5

There are a few adjectives that are accompanied by 'to', like, senior, junior, superior, inferior, preferable, prefer, elder. Do not use 'than' with these adjectives.

- I am elder than her. 
- I am elder to her. 

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 5

There are a few adjectives that are accompanied by **'to'**, like, senior, junior, superior, inferior, preferable, prefer, elder. Do not use **'than'** with these adjectives.

- This brand is superior than that. 
- This brand is superior to that. 

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 6

When comparing two things, only similar things should be compared.

- This wall colour is better than the parlour. **X**
- This wall colour is better than that of the parlour. 

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 7 (a)

- When the comparative degree is used in the superlative degree sense:
- Use 'any other' when thing/person of the same group is compared.

Jim is faster than any student in his class. **X**

Jim is faster than any other student in his class. ✓

Jim is the fastest student in his class. ✓

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 7 (b)

- When the comparative degree is used in the superlative degree sense:
- Use 'any' if comparison of things/person is outside the group.

Delhi is cleaner than any other city in Italy. **X**

Delhi is cleaner than any city in Italy. 

Delhi is cleaner than any other city in India. 

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 8

When in the same sentence two adjectives in different degrees of comparison are used, both should be complete in themselves.

- She is as good if not better than her sister. **X**
- She is as good as, if not better than her sister. 

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 9 (a)

To show whether the difference between the compared thing/person is small or big, we use quantifiers for the comparative degree of an adjective such as (a bit, a little, a lot, far, much, a great deal, significantly etc.).

- My hostel is only **marginally** bigger than yours.
- She is **a little** more popular than her sister in their school.
- Australia is **slightly** smaller than Africa.

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 9 (b)

We don't use quantifiers with superlative degrees of adjectives but there are certain phrases commonly used with the superlative degrees of comparison.

- Metros are **by far the** cheapest mode of travel.
- Sanskrit is **one of the** oldest languages in the world.
- Siddhivinayak is **the second** richest temple in India.

Degrees of Comparison: Rule 10

While changing the degree of comparison for the irregular adjectives, the word completely changes instead of adding 'er' or 'est'..

- She has **little** milk in the jar.
- She has **less** knowledge than he has. (not him)
- She has the **least** amount of money in the bank.

When we compare one thing with itself, we do not use "the":

England is **coldest** in winter. (not the coldest)

BUT

Finland is **the coldest** country in Europe.

My boss is **most generous** when we get a big order. (not the most generous)

Let's See!

- A. America is richer country in the world.
- B. America is the richest country in the world.
- C. America is the most rich country in the world.
- D. America is richer than other country in the world.

Let's See!

- A. America is richer country in the world.
- B. America is the richest country in the world.
- C. America is the most rich country in the world.
- D. America is richer than other country in the world.

Let's See!

- A. They say Rishi is smartest than any other students in the class.
- B. They say Rishi is the most smart than any other student in the class.
- C. They say Rishi is smarter than any other student in the class.
- D. They say Rishi is smart of all student in the class.

Let's See!

- A. They say Rishi is smartest than any other students in the class.
- B. They say Rishi is the most smart than any other student in the class.
- C. They say Rishi is smarter than any other student in the class.
- D. They say Rishi is smart of all student in the class.

Let's See!

- A. Delhi is worst than Mumbai in population.
- B. Delhi is as bad like Mumbai in terms of population.
- C. Delhi is more bad than Mumbai in terms of population.
- D. Delhi is worse than Mumbai in terms of population.

Let's See!

- A. Delhi is worst than Mumbai in population.
- B. Delhi is as bad like Mumbai in terms of population.
- C. Delhi is more bad than Mumbai in terms of population.
- D. Delhi is worse than Mumbai in terms of population.

Let's See!

- A. My sisters are much better than her sisters in studies.
- B. My sisters are good than her sisters in studies.
- C. My sisters are much good than her sisters is studies.
- D. My sisters are more good than her sisters in studies.

Let's See!

- A. My sisters are much better than her sisters in studies.
- B. My sisters are good than her sisters in studies.
- C. My sisters are much good than her sisters is studies.
- D. My sisters are more good than her sisters in studies.

Let's See!

- A. Rama's position is superior than the one held by Shyama.
- B. Rama's position is superior to the one held by Shyama.
- C. Rama's position is much superior than the one held by Shyama.
- D. Rama's position is more superior to the one held by Shyama.

Let's See!

- A. Rama's position is superior than the one held by Shyama.
- B. Rama's position is superior to the one held by Shyama.
- C. Rama's position is much superior than the one held by Shyama.
- D. Rama's position is more superior to the one held by Shyama.

Let's See!

"The characteristics of their new software are superior to..."

- A. the old software.
- B. that of the old software.
- C. the old software's.
- D. those of the old software.

Let's See!

"The characteristics of their new software are superior to..."

- A. the old software.
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Let's See!

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Let's See!

In the sentence, "The engine noise of this motorcycle is louder than the scooter," what structural element is missing to make the comparison logical?

- A. The phrase 'the noise of' before the scooter.
- B. The demonstrative pronoun 'those'.
- C. The comparison word 'more'.
- D. The singular demonstrative pronoun 'that of'.

Let's See!

In the sentence, "The engine noise of this motorcycle is louder than the scooter," what structural element is missing to make the comparison logical?

- A. The phrase 'the noise of' before the scooter.
- B. The demonstrative pronoun 'those of'.
- C. The comparison word 'more of'.
- D. The singular demonstrative pronoun 'that of'.

Let's See!

Identify the error: "The farther we walked into the forest, the more deeper the silence became."

- A. The further we walked - no error
- B. into the forest - no error
- C. the more deeper - error
- D. the silence became - no error

Let's See!

Identify the error: "The farther we walked into the forest, the more deeper the silence became."

- A. The further we walked - no error
- B. into the forest - no error
- C. the more deeper - error
- D. the silence became - no error

Answer: C

Explanation: This is a double comparative error. "More deeper" is incorrect; it should be "the deeper." In parallel comparative constructions (the...the...), use simple comparative forms without "more".